JOHN BLACKMON

Systems Engineer, Architect, and Administrator

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a highly-skilled solution architect with the ability to design and implement across a wide range of platforms and environments. My areas of particular expertise include virtualization, security, and automation. I have a proven track record of acquiring new skills by self-study and am routinely assigned to tasks where acquisition of a new skill set is necessary.

A few examples of my accomplishments and experience follow:

- Designing and building enterprise replication/failover systems
- Managing full application stacks
- Automating configuration and compliance for Apache using scripting as needed
- Architecting, building, deploying, and securing infrastructure and applications in AWS and various other data center environments with Terraform and Ansible
- Automating security policies with Ansible, SCAP, and shell scripts

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Leidos - Stennis Space Center, MS (March 2024 - July 2026)

Senior Linux Systems Administrator

- Linux team lead for the US Navy and DoD in their high-performance computing (HPC) center
- Led successful migration and deployment from Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) 7 to RHEL 8
- Built and deployed tools for enhanced compliance auditing and remediation

Geocent (acquired by Sev1Tech) - Stennis Space Center, MS (January 2011 - January 2024)

Senior Systems Administrator / Senior Systems Analyst (January 2017 - January 2024)

- Served as technical expert for multiple projects and agencies
- Worked as a DevOps engineer, writing Terraform and Ansible code for AWS as part of an Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) implementation
- Wrote Ansible code to implement DISA Security Technical Implementation Guides (STIGs) for RHEL and Apache
- Built new AWS GovCloud environments for testing and development of applications, and created and deployed RHEL and Windows test environments for every project
- Designed and implemented a central log storage solution for auditing, searching, and alerting of systems hosted by multiple Cloud Service Providers (CSPs), including Linux and Windows servers and Cisco network devices
- Designed network segments and subnets, host placement, and traffic for government agencies

Senior Systems Administrator (March 2012 - January 2017)

- Designed and applied the system security plan for the Oracle infrastructure and built the Oracle test/development environment
- Configured smart card (PKI token) logon for a secure domain and integrated Linux and Mac systems into the domain infrastructure
- Centralized and combined patch management for systems and applications for quick response to Information Assurance Vulnerability Alert (IAVA) requirements
- Managed domain infrastructure including Active Directory (AD), and migrated Microsoft Exchange

Systems Administrator (January 2011 - March 2012)

- Designed the disaster recovery solution including standby site and replication architecture for the enterprise replication/failover project
- Resolved conflicts between enterprise application hosting architectures between sites to deploy common packages to both

- Developed tools and scripts for combining web applications and settings into unified RPM packages that could be deployed from a central server, and "installed" to stand up and start a new, working instance of the entire stack

Blackmon Consulting - Long Beach, MS (January 2010 - January 2011)

Owner / Principal Consultant

- I was a private contractor providing custom technology and security consulting services.

Matrix-DSS - Falls Church, VA (October 2008 - December 2009)

Senior Systems Engineer

- Managed the full application stack as lead engineer for the US Government
- Integrated statistical equations from the Applied Physics Laboratory at Johns Hopkins University, GIS, Cognos reporting, WebSphere Application Server, and backend database during a major upgrade of all components
- Created new development and test environments for multiple government agencies

Advanced Broadband Systems, Inc. - Falls Church, VA (February 2007 - October 2008)

Senior AIX Engineer

- Led the enterprise web and application server upgrade, and consolidation of nodes and a clustered SAN between redundant sites for the US Government
- Automated security compliance and auditing

URS Corporation - Gulfport, MS (February 2003 - February 2007)

Senior AIX Systems Administrator

- Served as senior systems administrator of IBM AIX systems for nine states and two territories, responsible for 23 support facilities

CERTIFICATIONS

These are current and actively maintained or do not expire.

- IBM Certified Advanced Technical Expert (CATE), AIX
- IBM AIX v7 Administrator Specialty
- CompTIA SecurityX (formerly CASP) and CompTIA Security+ CE
- CompTIA Linux+

Previously earned:

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), #646660
- ISACA Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)
- AWS Certified SysOps Administrator (Associate)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect (Associate)
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA), Routing and Switching

EDUCATION

University of Mississippi - Oxford, MS (Fall 1998 - Spring 2001)

Undergraduate Coursework toward B.S. in Biology (Pre-Medicine) - No Degree Conferred

- Awarded the Frederic A. P. Barnard Scholarship, the university's highest academic scholarship, a full merit-based award